

Volta Coffee Wholesale Order Triage Workflow

Project Brief

Project Overview

The aim of this project is to automate the first stage of processing wholesale coffee orders for Volta Coffee Roasters. Currently, wholesale orders need to be reviewed manually before they can be processed. This workflow is designed to reduce repetitive work by extracting important information from customer messages, classifying each order, and preparing the next steps for the Operations Manager.

AI is only used for tasks that require understanding natural language, such as extracting order details and classifying the order. All other actions, including storing data and routing the workflow, are handled using standard workflow logic to ensure consistent and predictable results.

Workflow Trigger

The workflow starts when a wholesale customer submits an order using an n8n form. The form collects the customer's email address and the complete order message. I chose a form trigger because it provides structured input while still allowing customers to describe their order in their own words.

Workflow Output

For each submitted order, the workflow will:

- extract customer information, products, quantities, and any special notes from the order;
- classify the order as **standard**, **needs_review**, or **needs_clarification**;
- store the structured order in an Airtable database;
- create a Gmail draft for standard orders;
- send a Slack notification for orders that require manual review;
- send a Slack notification when additional information is needed before the order can be processed.

The workflow does not automatically send emails to customers. The Operations Manager remains responsible for reviewing and approving all customer communication.

Success Criteria

The workflow will be considered successful if it correctly processes the sample wholesale orders provided in the assignment, extracts the required information into a structured format, stores every order in Airtable, and routes each order to the correct outcome. Standard orders should generate Gmail drafts, while complex or incomplete orders should be flagged for manual review through Slack.

Project Scope

This project focuses on supporting the initial processing of wholesale coffee orders. It automates information extraction, order classification, data storage, and workflow routing while keeping a human involved in all final customer-facing decisions.

Out of Scope

This workflow does not connect directly to WhatsApp or other messaging platforms. It does not automatically send emails, process payments, update inventory, manage coffee production schedules, or make commercial decisions. These tasks remain outside the scope of this project and continue to require human supervision.